

Android Custom ROMs and Recovery Images You Could Choose From

Android has provided a great platform for developers and enthusiasts alike with so many custom ROMs and recovery images available as open source projects. Often, enthusiasts and everyday users have difficulty in deciding which custom ROM to install on their devices. This article will help the reader to make a more informed choice.



Mobile OSs today offer a variety of features in apps, settings and UIs. But they still have limitations. As an alternative to this, 'jail-breaking' or custom ROMs are provided by OS vendors to provide additional features, flexibility and customisation of apps, settings or the UI to customers. While the recovery images are limited to boot mode, with stock recovery, one can install OTA updates, wipe system data or cache the partition. These options limit the system's functionality, which typically allows only manufacturers' updates to be pushed to devices. With custom recovery ROMs, there is more functionality over the stock recovery ROMs. For instance, one can make a full device backup, which can later be restored if Android behaves in an unrecoverable fashion.

Custom ROMs are modified versions of the Android OS and with them, the end user can create tweaks, skins, custom themes or new apps. Custom ROMs also add to the performance, with many more improvements to smartphones or tablets. Moreover, with these custom ROMs, one can flash newer or unreleased versions of the Android OS to one's device – even those not available due to restrictions from

manufacturers or vendors. Let's take a look at a few trending open source Android custom ROMs and recovery images that are essential for the Android OS, as the officially released OS don't provide many features for recovery.

CyanogenMod 12

Commonly referred to as CM, this is an open source, after-market firmware for a number of cell phones based on the Android operating system. It offers features not available in the official Android based firmware of the vendors. It also offers a lot of customisation (native theming, Privacy Guard, unlockable bootloader, root access and a lot more) and has support from many developers. Refer to <http://www.cyanogenmod.org/devices> for a list of supported devices.

OmniROM

OmniROM is yet another custom ROM for Android devices; "Omni isn't better, it's just different," claim the Omni developers. Active Display, Flick2Wake, Pick2Wake, customised status and the notification drawer and launcher are some of the features provided by this ROM. Updates are on